

For Tonight's Exhibition Tilt— Diablos-Miners Discuss 'Trade'

By PETE CICCARELLI

Baseball's definition of a "good trade" is a transaction that proves profitable to all parties concerned. In that case, Diablo manager Jimmy Williams and University of Texas at El Paso coach Andy Cohen might do well to sit a spell at the bargaining table before today's 7 p.m. exhibition tilt in Dudley Field.

It seems as though Cohen is in bad need of pitching, certainly a Diablo commodity. There is a definite possibility that Williams, on the other hand, may become an involuntary third baseman tonight if regular thirdsacker Paul Dade doesn't arrive for gametime.

DADE LEFT the California Angels' minor league complex in Holtville, Calif. late last week to return to his home in Seattle, Wash. because of an illness in his family. Paul is supposed to check in at Dudley late this afternoon but if his connections are delayed, well...

"Absolutely no way," Jimmy exclaims when asked if he may don playing spikes tonight. "I'm only 31, but it's an old 31," the ex-Cardinal, Met and Expo infielder protests.

The Diablos' 21-man roster which will open defense of the team's 1974 Western Division, Texas League title Friday in Midland does not include a spare infielder. The closest thing Jimmy has to a backup is vet flyhawk Sam Ashford, who can guard the hot corner in a dire emergency.

As previously stated, the hardhitting and speedy Dade is due for gametime. But if he's delayed, Jimmy Plans on calling it a "dire emergency."

WHILE JIMMY might be reluctant to offer Cohen a hurler for a one-day third baseman, it is possible that he would loan the Miners by such a rental.

"There were so many pitchers in spring training that hardly anybody got in any work," E.P. No. 2 starter Jim Officer relates. "Heck, I only threw 11 innings all spring and a lot of guys didn't get that many in."

Williams will use several of his hurlers tonight including strong-armed righties Bill Rothan and Tom Whiteley and fire chief John Verhoeven, a 6-5 northsider with a rare combination of smoking fastballs and fluttering knucklers.

THE MINERS' Cohen is still undecided on his rotation this evening. At present, Andy could probably draw names from a hat and get comparable results to the efforts his staff has turned in over the past five games... 66 runs and 89 hits in three losses to Western Athletic Conference foe Arizona and two setbacks at New Mexico State (5-4 and 8-2 yesterday).

To make matters worse for the Orange, they host Arizona State in a three-game series this weekend. Tonight is only an exhibition tilt and Andy must keep his more reliable arms rested for the bombers from Tempe.

"EXORCISMS" — Forget Marty Friedman. It was learned yesterday that Salt Lake centerfielder Rusty Torres' "bruised" thumb was actually broken in two spots and he'll be in a cast until June. Friedman still might return then but the odds are against that... Marty is too good a ballplayer to blow the AAA chance he's getting now.

Tonight's game can be heard on KLOZ-FM with the voice of the Diablos, Ed Mueller, handling play-by-play.

All proceeds from tonight's game (admission is one portrait of George Washington on a piece of 6" by 2½" government issued paper) will go to UTEP's athletic department.